

TOPIC 1: LISTENSING TO GRASP MAIN POINTS IN A POEM

Poetry is an imaginative and emotional creative work of art meant to stimulate thought and to be enjoyed. It is the sum total of the use of certain devices in writing such as rhythm, rhymes, meter, figure of speech, stanza, verse, the poet's feeling and attitude to the subject matter etc.

TYPES OF POETRY

1. Narrative poem: A poem that tells a story.
2. Lyrics poem: A poem that is musical in nature
3. Dramatic poem: Poem involving characters that interact in verse form.
4. Sonnet: A 14 lines poem. We have two types of sonnet.
 - a. Petrarchan Italian sonnet divided into octave and sestet with rhyming scheme of abba, abba, ade, ade.
 - b. Shakespearean sonnet which has 3 set of four lines followed by a couplet.
5. Pastoral poem: Poem on a country side or rural life
6. Dirge: A poem for the dead.
7. Epigram: Poem about the deeds of great people.
8. Ode: Poem that addresses a person or thing.

Others include: satire, ballad, epic, limerick, elegy etc.

POETIC DEVICES

1. Verses/stanza: Poetry is written in verses or in stanzas. A stanza may be made up of 4 lines or more
2. Imagery: Imagery is a mind picture. It is a collection of images or a mental picture called in mind by the use of concrete expression to appeal to the reader's sense of imagination.
3. Language: The language is the writer's choice of words. It is also called "Diction". The writer may choose to make his language simple and sometimes difficult. Poetry makes use of rhyme unlike prose.
4. Setting: This is the time and place of the events or actions in a poem.
5. Figure of speech: A phrase or a word having different meaning than its literal meanings.

ASSIGNMENT: Night rain is a poem written by John Pepper Clark on his experience as a boy. Listen carefully as the poem is read on page 230 and answer the questions on unit 5 page 66.

CLASS ACTIVITIES

AFRICA BY R.E.G AMARHOE

I saw a maiden dark and lovely, sitting by a wayside, sad and lovely Oh pretty maiden, so dark and comely. Why sit by the wayside, sad and lonely? I am neither sad nor lonely, she said, but living, Sir, among the deaf and dumb, Relentlessly watching these shameless dead.

Makes my warm heart grow very cold and dumb.

The analysis of the above poem.

The poem is an elegy (a poem that expresses sadness) it talks about a pretty lady with a warm heart who later became sad because of the circumstances that surround her.

Devices used in the poem

1. Setting: by the wayside – along the road
2. Rhyming scheme: AB, AB, CD, CD.
3. Imagery: pretty maiden, wayside, deaf and dumb, shameless, dead, heart.
4. Figure of speech: Metaphor

Answers to the questions on the poem Pg 77 New concept English.

1. The mood of the maiden is sadness.
Line 8 shows the evidence “makes warm heart grow very cold and numb.
2. The lady felt that way because she is living among people that have no feelings.
Line 6.
3. The lady referred to here is a pretty maiden.
4. She is from Africa- People from dark origin.
5. Personification
6. It is a metaphor
7. Bad, dark, lonely, deaf, cold, numb.